12. Redemption

The tranquillity of Sugar Ridge, a $50-million, 43-acre complex overlooking Jolly Harbour on Antigua's west coast, was deceptive. It might specialize in mindfulness and modern pampering, but over two long nights, locked in discussion with Peter Moores, it looked as if that was where my England Test captaincy would effectively come to an end.

Normally, the tougher the situation in which I find myself, the more resolute I become, but this was an extended cry for help, during a drawn Test match at a time of transition. The Gimp was working overtime on my shoulder, telling me that I didn't need the pressure. Until I poured my heart out to Peter, I was set on retiring at the end of the three-match series in the Caribbean.

Although, behind the scenes, moves were being made to appoint Andrew Strauss to the newly created role of England's director of cricket, the lessons of the previous fifteen months had not been heeded. I craved certainty, rather than well-meaning but damagingly casual interpretations of the situation regarding Kevin Pietersen.

The media, loving the ambiguities of the story, were disinclined to take no for an answer, and needed little encouragement from Colin Graves, the incoming chairman of the ECB. He had muddied the waters in an interview with the BBC in early March by suggesting that KP could only be considered for an England recall if he was consistently scoring runs in county cricket.